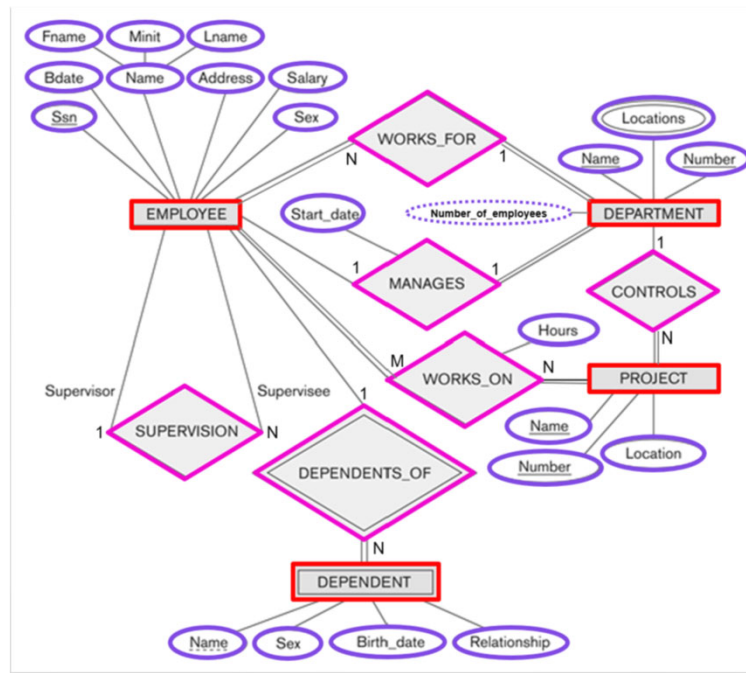


Chapter 3

The Relational Data Model and Relational Database Constraints

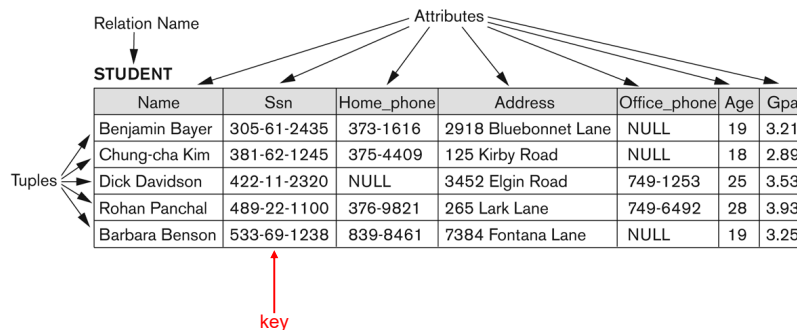
1



2

Informal Definition

Informally, a **relation** looks like a **table** of values.



3

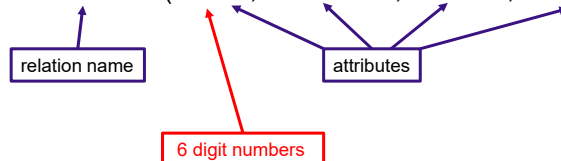
Formal Definitions - Schema

The **Schema** (or description) of a Relation:

- Denoted by $R(A_1, A_2, \dots, A_n)$
- R is the **name** of the relation (table)
- The **attributes** of the relation are $A_1, A_2, \dots, A_n$

Example:

CUSTOMER (CustId, Cust-name, Address, PhoneNo)



Each attribute has a **domain** or a set of valid values.

4

Formal Definitions - Tuple

A **tuple** (row) is an ordered set of values (in angled brackets <...>)

Each value is taken from the appropriate **domain**.

A row in the CUSTOMER relation is a 4-tuple consisting of four values:

< 632895, "John Smith", "101 Main St., Atlanta, GA 30332", "404-894-2000" >

A **relation** (table) is a **set** of such tuples (rows)

5

The Relation STUDENT (schema and state)

Name	Ssn	Home_phone	Address	Office_phone	Age	Gpa
Benjamin Bayer	305-61-2435	373-1616	2918 Bluebonnet Lane	NULL	19	3.21
Chung-cha Kim	381-62-1245	375-4409	125 Kirby Road	NULL	18	2.89
Dick Davidson	422-11-2320	NULL	3452 Elgin Road	749-1253	25	3.53
Rohan Panchal	489-22-1100	376-9821	265 Lark Lane	749-6492	28	3.93
Barbara Benson	533-69-1238	839-8461	7384 Fontana Lane	NULL	19	3.25

6

Characteristics of Relations

The tuples (rows) in a relation (table) are a set, thus **not ordered**, even though they appear to be in the table.

The attributes (columns) in a tuple **are ordered**.

7

Relational Integrity Constraints

Constraints are **conditions** that must hold on **all** valid relation states:

- **Domain** constraints
- **Key** constraints
- **Entity integrity** constraints
- **Referential integrity** constraints

8

Domain Constraints

Every value in a tuple must be from the **domain of its attribute**
(or it could be **null**, if allowed for that attribute)

A valid row in the CUSTOMER relation:

< 632895, "John Smith", "101 Main St., Atlanta, GA 30332", "404-894-2000" >

An invalid row in the CUSTOMER relation:

< A65F76, "John Smith", "101 Main St., Atlanta, GA 30332", "404-894-2000" >

9

Key Constraints

A **superkey** of R is a set of attributes SK of R such that no two tuples in any valid state of R have the same values for SK

A **key** of R is a "minimal" superkey, i.e. removal of any attribute from K results in a set of attributes that is not a superkey.

No two tuples of R may have the same key value.

For any two distinct tuples $t_1, t_2 \in r(R)$: $t_1[K] \neq t_2[K]$

Example: In the CAR relation schema:

CAR (State, RegNo, SerialNo, Make, Model, Year)

CAR has two keys:

- Key1 = {State, RegNo}
- Key2 = {SerialNo}

Both are also superkeys of CAR

{SerialNo, Make} is a superkey but **not** a key.

10

Keys

Student_ID	Student_Enroll	Student_Name	Student_Email
S02	4545	Dave	dave@gmail.com
S34	4541	Jack	jack@njit.edu
S22	4555	Mark	mark1@gmail.com
S23	4545	Mark	mark2@gmail.com

Candidate keys:

{Student_ID}

{Student_Email}

11

Keys

If a relation has several **candidate keys**, one is chosen to be the **primary key**. The primary key attributes are **underlined**.

CAR

<u>License_number</u>	Engine_serial_number	Make	Model	Year
Texas ABC-739	A69352	Ford	Mustang	02
Florida TVP-347	B43696	Oldsmobile	Cutlass	05
New York MPO-22	X83554	Oldsmobile	Delta	01
California 432-TFY	C43742	Mercedes	190-D	99
California RSK-629	Y82935	Toyota	Camry	04
Texas RSK-629	U028365	Jaguar	XJS	04

License_number is the primary key

Engine_serial_number is a candidate key

12

Entity Integrity Constraint

The **primary key attributes** PK of each relation schema R cannot have null values in any tuple:

$$t[PK] \neq \text{null for all tuples } t \in r(R)$$

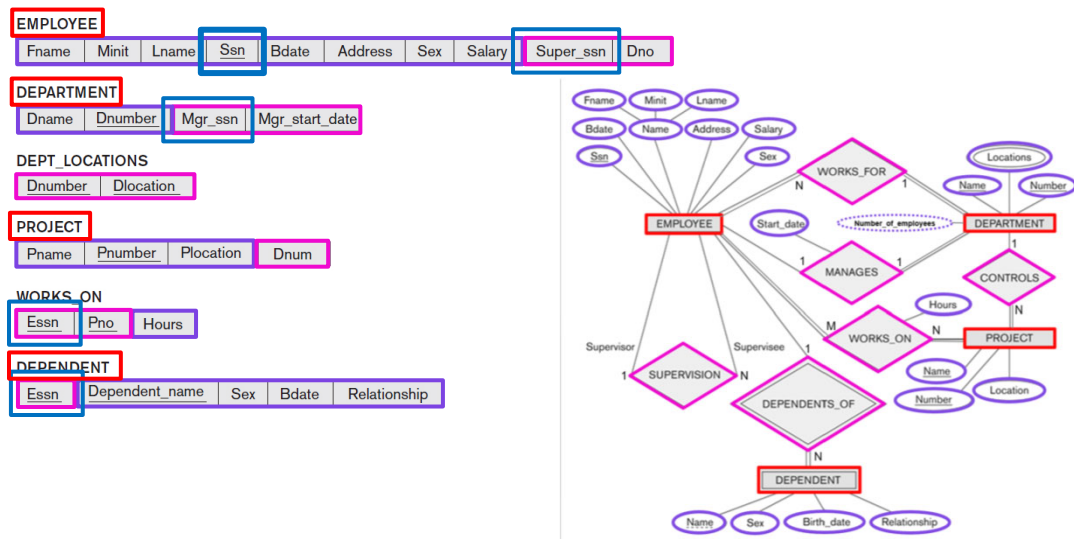
This is because primary key values are used to **identify** the individual tuples.

If PK has several attributes, **null** is not allowed in any of these attributes.

Note: Other attributes of R may be constrained to disallow null values, even though they are not members of the primary key.

13

COMPANY Database Schema



14

EMPLOYEE										DEPT_LOCATIONS		WORKS_ON		
Fname	Minit	Lname	Ssn	Bdate	Address	Sex	Salary	Super_ssn	Dno	Dnumber	Dlocation	Essn	Pno	Hours
John	B	Smith	123456789	1965-01-09	731 Fondren, Houston, TX	M	30000	333445555	5	1	Houston	123456789	1	32.5
Franklin	T	Wong	333445555	1955-12-08	638 Voss, Houston, TX	M	40000	888665555	5	4	Stafford	123456789	2	7.5
Alicia	J	Zelaya	999887777	1968-01-19	3321 Castle, Spring, TX	F	25000	987654321	4	5	Bellaire	666884444	3	40.0
Jennifer	S	Wallace	987654321	1941-06-20	291 Berry, Bellaire, TX	F	43000	888665555	4	5	Sugarland	453453453	1	20.0
Ramesh	K	Narayan	666884444	1962-09-15	975 Fire Oak, Humble, TX	M	38000	333445555	5	5	Houston	453453453	2	20.0
Joyce	A	English	453453453	1972-07-31	5631 Rice, Houston, TX	F	25000	333445555	5			333445555	2	10.0
Ahmad	V	Jabbar	987987987	1969-03-29	980 Dallas, Houston, TX	M	25000	987654321	4			333445555	3	10.0
James	E	Borg	888665555	1937-11-10	450 Stone, Houston, TX	M	55000	NULL	1			333445555	10	10.0

Dname	Dnumber	Mgr_ssn	Mgr_start_date
Research	5	333445555	1988-05-22
Administration	4	987654321	1995-01-01
Headquarters	1	888665555	1981-06-19

Pname	Pnumber	Plocation	Dnum
ProductX	1	Bellaire	5
ProductY	2	Sugarland	5
ProductZ	3	Houston	5
Computerization	10	Stafford	4
Reorganization	20	Houston	1
Newbenefits	30	Stafford	4

Essn	Dependent_name	Sex	Bdate	Relationship
333445555	Alice	F	1986-04-05	Daughter
333445555	Theodore	M	1983-10-25	Son
333445555	Joy	F	1958-05-03	Spouse
987654321	Abner	M	1942-02-28	Spouse
123456789	Michael	M	1988-01-04	Son
123456789	Alice	F	1988-12-30	Daughter
123456789	Elizabeth	F	1967-05-05	Spouse

15

Referential Integrity

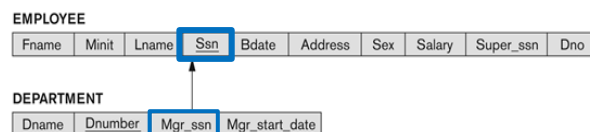
Used to specify a connection between tuples in *two* relations:

- The **referencing relation** and the **referenced relation**.

Tuples in the **referencing relation** R_1 have **foreign key** attributes FK that reference the primary key attributes PK of the **referenced relation** R_2 .

- A tuple $t_1 \in R_1$ is said to **reference** a tuple $t_2 \in R_2$ if $t_1[FK] = t_2[PK]$

A referential integrity constraint is displayed in a relational database schema as an arrow from $R_1.FK$ to $R_2.PK$.



16

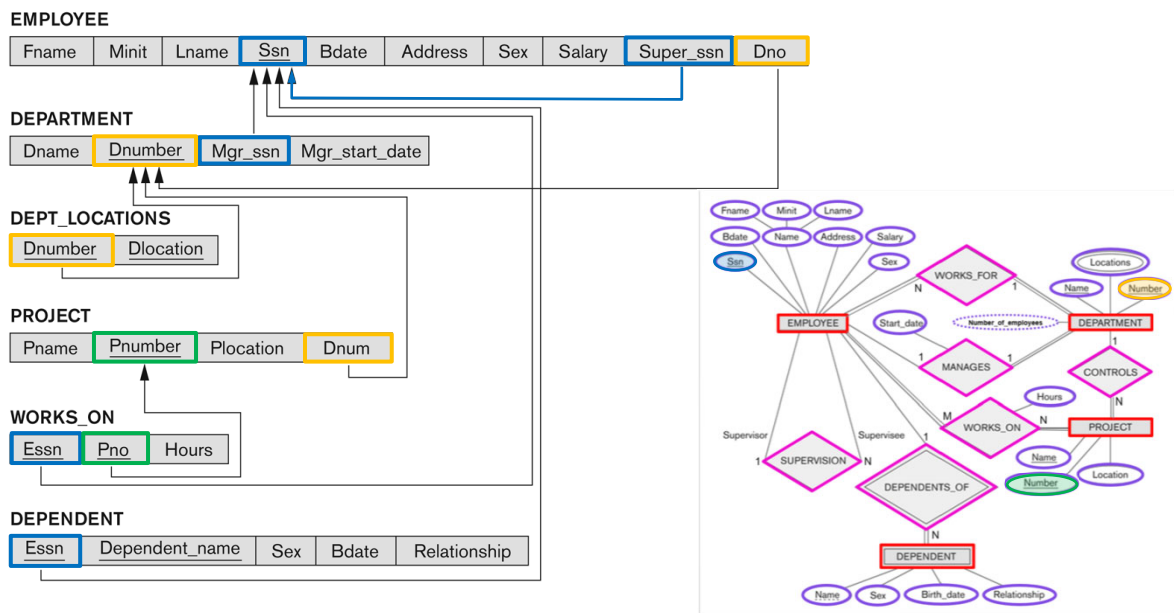
Referential Integrity (or Foreign Key) Constraint

The value in the foreign key column (or columns) FK of the **referencing relation** R_1 can be either:

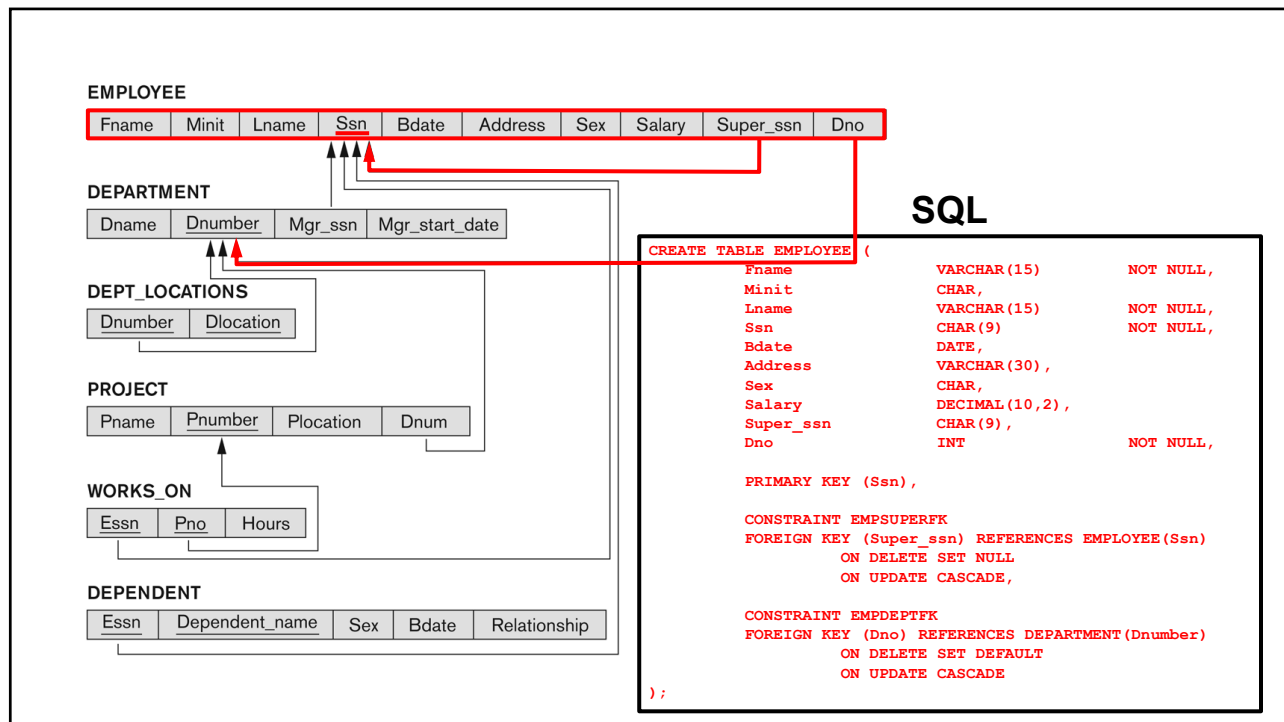
- a value of an existing primary key value of a corresponding primary key PK in the **referenced relation** R_2
- a **null**. The FK in R_1 typically should **not** be its own primary key.

17

Referential Integrity Constraints for COMPANY Database



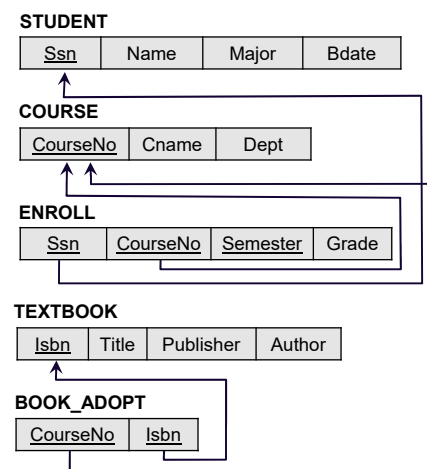
18



19

Example

Relations in a database that keeps track of student enrollment in courses and the books adopted for each course.



20

Update Operations on Relations

- INSERT a tuple.
- DELETE a tuple.
- MODIFY a tuple.
- Integrity constraints should not be violated by the update operations.
- Several update operations may have to be grouped together.
- Updates may **propagate** to cause other updates automatically. This may be necessary to maintain integrity constraints.

21

Update Operations on Relations

In case of integrity violation, several actions can be taken:

- Cancel the operation that causes the violation (RESTRICT or REJECT option)
- Perform the operation but inform the user of the violation
- Trigger additional updates so the violation is corrected (CASCADE option, SET NULL option)
- Execute a user-specified error-correction routine

22

INSERT Examples

Operation:

Insert <'Cecilia', 'F', 'Kolonsky', **NULL**, '1960-04-05', '6357 Windy Lane, Katy, TX', F, 28000, NULL, 4> into EMPLOYEE.

Result: Violates the entity integrity constraint (NULL for the primary key Ssn).

Operation:

Insert <'Cecilia', 'F', 'Kolonsky', '**999887777**', '1960-04-05', '6357 Windy Lane, Katy, TX', F, 28000, '987654321', 4> into EMPLOYEE.

Result: Violates the key constraint because another tuple with the same Ssn value already exists in the EMPLOYEE relation.

Operation:

Insert <'Cecilia', 'F', 'Kolonsky', '677678989', '1960-04-05', '6357 Windswept, Katy, TX', F, 28000, '987654321', 7> into EMPLOYEE.

Result: Violates the referential integrity constraint specified on Dno in EMPLOYEE because no corresponding referenced tuple exists in DEPARTMENT with Dnumber = 7.

EMPLOYEE										DEPT. LOCATIONS		WORKS ON		
Fname	Minit	Lname	Ssn	Bdate	Address	Sex	Salary	Super_ssn	Dno	Dnumber	Dlocation	Essn	Pno	Hours
John	B	Smith	123456789	1965-01-09	731 Fondren, Houston, TX	M	30000	333445555	5	1	Houston	123456789	1	32.5
Franklin	T	Wong	333445555	1955-12-08	638 Voss, Houston, TX	M	40000	888665555	5	4	Stafford	123456789	2	7.5
Alicia	J	Zelaya	999887777	1968-01-19	3321 Castle, Spring, TX	F	25000	987654321	4	5	Bellaire	666884444	3	40.0
Jennifer	S	Wallace	987654321	1941-06-20	291 Berry, Bellaire, TX	F	43000	888665555	4	5	Sugarland	453453453	1	20.0
Ramesh	K	Narayan	666884444	1962-09-15	975 Fire Oak, Humble, TX	M	38000	333445555	5	5	Houston	333445555	2	10.0
Joyce	A	English	453453453	1972-07-31	5831 Rice, Houston, TX	F	25000	333445555	5			333445555	3	10.0
Ahmad	V	Jabbar	987987987	1969-03-29	980 Dallas, Houston, TX	M	25000	987654321	4			333445555	10	10.0
James	E	Borg	888665555	1937-11-10	450 Stone, Houston, TX	M	55000	NULL	1			333445555	20	10.0

DEPARTMENT			
Dname	Dnumber	Mgr_ssn	Mgr_start_date
Research	5	333445555	1988-05-22
Administration	4	987654321	1995-01-01
Headquarters	1	888665555	1981-06-19

PROJECT			
Pname	Pnumber	Plocation	Dnum
ProductX	1	Bellaire	5
ProductY	2	Sugarland	5
ProductZ	3	Houston	5
Computerization	10	Stafford	4
Reorganization	20	Houston	1
Newbenefits	30	Stafford	4

DEPENDENT					
Essn	Dependent_name	Sex	Bdate	Relationship	
333445555	Alice	F	1986-04-05	Daughter	
333445555	Theodore	M	1983-10-25	Son	
333445555	Joy	F	1958-05-03	Spouse	
987654321	Abner	M	1942-02-28	Spouse	
123456789	Michael	M	1988-01-04	Son	
123456789	Alice	F	1988-12-30	Daughter	
123456789	Elizabeth	F	1987-05-05	Spouse	

23

Possible Violations for INSERT

INSERT may violate any of the constraints:

- Domain constraint:
 - if one of the attribute values provided for the new tuple is not of the specified attribute domain
- Key constraint:
 - if the value of a key attribute in the new tuple already exists in another tuple in the relation
- Entity integrity:
 - if the primary key value is null in the new tuple
- Referential integrity:
 - if a foreign key value in the new tuple uses a primary key value that does not exist in the referenced relation

24

DELETE Examples

Operation:

Delete the WORKS_ON tuple with Essn = '999887777' and Pno = 10.

Result: Acceptable. Deletes exactly one tuple.

Operation:

Delete the EMPLOYEE tuple with Ssn = '333445555'.

Result: Will result in referential integrity violations, because this Ssn is referenced by tuples from the EMPLOYEE, DEPARTMENT, WORKS_ON and DEPENDENT relations.

Operation:

Delete the EMPLOYEE tuple with Ssn = '999887777'.

Result: Will result in referential integrity violations, because there are tuples in WORKS_ON that refer to this Ssn.

EMPLOYEE										DEPT. LOCATIONS		WORKS_ON		
Fname	Minit	Lname	Ssn	Bdate	Address	Sex	Salary	Super_ssn	Dno	Dnumber	Dlocation	Essn	Pno	Hours
John	B	Smith	123456789	1965-01-09	731 Fondren, Houston, TX	M	30000	333445555	5	1	Houston	123456789	1	32.5
Franklin	T	Wong	333445555	1955-12-08	638 Voss, Houston, TX	M	40000	888665555	5	4	Stafford	123456789	2	7.5
Alicia	J	Zelaya	999887777	1968-01-19	3321 Castle, Spring, TX	F	25000	987654321	4	5	Bellaire	666884444	3	40.0
Jennifer	S	Wallace	987654321	1941-06-20	291 Berry, Bellaire, TX	F	43000	888665555	4	5	Sugarland	453453453	1	20.0
Ramesh	K	Narayan	666884444	1962-09-15	975 Fire Oak, Humble, TX	M	38000	333445555	5	5	Houston	453453453	2	20.0
Joyce	A	English	453453453	1972-07-31	5631 Rice, Houston, TX	F	25000	333445555	5			333445555	2	10.0
Ahmad	V	Jabbar	987987987	1969-03-29	980 Dallas, Houston, TX	M	25000	987654321	4			333445555	3	10.0
James	E	Borg	888665555	1937-11-10	450 Stone, Houston, TX	M	55000	NULL	1			333445555	10	10.0
												333445555	20	10.0
												999887777	30	30.0
												999887777	10	10.0
												987987987	10	35.0
												987987987	30	5.0
												987654321	30	20.0
												987654321	20	15.0
												888665555	20	NULL

DEPARTMENT			
Dname	Dnumber	Mgr_ssn	Mgr_start_date
Research	5	333445555	1988-05-22
Administration	4	987654321	1995-01-01
Headquarters	1	888665555	1981-06-19

PROJECT			
Pname	Pnumber	Plocation	Dnum
ProductX	1	Bellaire	5
ProductY	2	Sugarland	5
ProductZ	3	Houston	5
Computerization	10	Stafford	4
Reorganization	20	Houston	1
Newbenefits	30	Stafford	4

DEPENDENT				
Essn	Dependent_name	Sex	Bdate	Relationship
333445555	Alice	F	1986-04-05	Daughter
333445555	Theodore	M	1989-10-25	Son
333445555	Joy	F	1958-05-03	Spouse
987654321	Abner	M	1942-02-28	Spouse
123456789	Michael	M	1989-01-04	Son
123456789	Alice	F	1988-12-30	Daughter
123456789	Elizabeth	F	1987-05-05	Spouse

25

Possible Violations for DELETE

DELETE may violate only referential integrity:

- If the primary key value of the tuple being deleted is used by other tuples (foreign keys) in the database
 - Can be remedied by several actions:
 - **RESTRICT**: reject the deletion
 - **CASCADE**: delete all other referencing tuples
 - **SET NULL**: set the foreign keys of the referencing tuples to NULL
- One of the above must be specified during database design for each foreign key constraint

26

MODIFY Examples

Operation:

Modify the salary of the EMPLOYEE tuple with Ssn = '999887777' to 28000.

Result: Acceptable.

Operation:

Modify the Dno of the EMPLOYEE tuple with Ssn = '999887777' to 7.

Result: Unacceptable, because it violates referential integrity.

Operation:

Modify the Dno of the EMPLOYEE tuple with Ssn = '999887777' to 1.

Result: Acceptable.

Operation:

Update the Ssn of the EMPLOYEE tuple with Ssn = '999887777' to '987654321'.

Result: Unacceptable, because it violates the key constraint by repeating a value that already exists as a primary key in another tuple. It also violates referential integrity constraints because there are other relations that refer to the existing value of Ssn.

EMPLOYEE										DEPT_LOCATIONS		WORKS_ON		
Fname	Minit	Lname	Ssn	Bdate	Address	Sex	Salary	Super_ssn	Dno	Dnumber	Dlocation	Essn	Pno	Hours
John	B	Smith	123456789	1965-01-09	731 Fondren, Houston, TX	M	30000	333445555	5	1	Houston	123456789	1	32.5
Franklin	T	Wong	333445555	1955-12-08	638 Voss, Houston, TX	M	40000	888665555	5	4	Stafford	123456789	2	7.5
Alicia	J	Zelaya	999887777	1968-01-19	3321 Castle, Spring, TX	F	25000	987654321	4	5	Bellaire	666884444	3	40.0
Jennifer	S	Wallace	987654321	1941-06-20	291 Berry, Bellaire, TX	F	43000	888665555	4	5	Sugarland	453453453	1	20.0
Ramesh	K	Narayan	666884444	1962-09-15	975 Fire Oak, Humble, TX	M	38000	333445555	5	5	Houston	453453453	2	20.0
Joyce	A	English	453453453	1972-07-31	5631 Rice, Houston, TX	F	25000	333445555	5			333445555	2	10.0
Ahmad	V	Jalilbar	987987987	1969-03-29	980 Dallas, Houston, TX	M	25000	987654321	4			333445555	3	10.0
James	E	Borg	888665555	1937-11-10	450 Stone, Houston, TX	M	55000	NULL	1			333445555	10	10.0

DEPARTMENT			
Dname	Dnumber	Mgr_ssn	Mgr_start_date
Research	5	333445555	1988-05-22
Administration	4	987654321	1995-01-01
Headquarters	1	888665555	1981-06-19

PROJECT			
Pname	Pnumber	Plocation	Pdnum
ProductX	1	Bellaire	5
ProductY	2	Sugarland	5
ProductZ	3	Houston	5
Computerization	10	Stafford	4
Reorganization	20	Houston	1
Newbenefits	30	Stafford	4

DEPENDENT					
Essn	Dependent_name	Sex	Bdate	Relationship	
333445555	Alice	F	1986-04-05	Daughter	
333445555	Theodore	M	1988-10-25	Son	
333445555	Joy	F	1958-05-03	Spouse	
987654321	Abner	M	1942-02-28	Spouse	
123456789	Michael	M	1988-01-04	Son	
123456789	Alice	F	1988-12-30	Daughter	
123456789	Elizabeth	F	1967-05-05	Spouse	

27

Possible Violations for MODIFY

MODIFY may violate the **domain constraint** and NOT NULL constraint on an attribute

Any of the other constraints may also be violated, depending on the attribute being modified:

- Modifying the primary key (PK):
 - Similar to a DELETE followed by an INSERT
 - Need to specify similar options to DELETE
- Modifying a foreign key (FK):
 - May violate referential integrity
- Modifying an ordinary attribute (neither PK nor FK):
 - Can only violate domain constraints

28

```
CREATE TABLE EMPLOYEE (  
    Fname          VARCHAR(15)    NOT NULL,  
    Minit          CHAR,            
    Lname          VARCHAR(15)    NOT NULL,  
    Ssn            CHAR(9)        NOT NULL,  
    Bdate          DATE,            
    Address        VARCHAR(30) ,  
    Sex            CHAR,            
    Salary         DECIMAL(10,2) ,  
    Super_ssn      CHAR(9) ,  
    Dno            INT            NOT NULL,  
  
    PRIMARY KEY (Ssn) ,  
  
    CONSTRAINT EMPSUPERFK  
    FOREIGN KEY (Super_ssn) REFERENCES EMPLOYEE(Ssn)  
        ON DELETE SET NULL  
        ON UPDATE CASCADE ,  
  
    CONSTRAINT EMPDEPTFK  
    FOREIGN KEY (Dno) REFERENCES DEPARTMENT(Dnumber)  
        ON DELETE SET DEFAULT  
        ON UPDATE CASCADE  
);
```